Hobbesian nor utopian. In fact, they tried to arrive at non-Hobbesian conclusions from Hobbesian premises. They did not reject the realists' emphasis on power and national interest and they did acknowledge that world politics is an "anarchical society" but, at the same time, they do contend that under conditions of anarchy, states act within a system of norms which, most of the time, is constraining. Therefore, the core element in their thought is that there is a presence of a world of sovereign states where both power and law are present. Power and national interest do matter, but norms and institutions also have great significance.[24]

However, with the end of Cold War and the dismemberment of the Soviet Union, the dominant paradigms in IR seemed unable to explain the prevailing situations. Therefore, new reflective critical ideas started gaining ground, which were a departure from the mainstream liberal, realist and orthodox Marxist thinking in IR. New debates have, therefore, arisen in IR addressing methodological as well as substantial issues. Currently a fourth debate is on its way, which challenges the established traditions in IR by alternative approaches. The new voices in IR are identified as *post-Positivist approaches* and the era that it has heralded has been identified by Yosef Lapid[¶¶] as *a post-Positivist* era.

Steve Smith[25] while considering the present theoretical perspectives of IR, puts IR theories into two broad categories:

- Explanatory theories that see the world as something external to our theories. Realists, pluralists and structural neo-Marxist theories tend to be explanatory theories, with their task being to report on a world that is external to theories. In this endeavour, they attempt to find regularities in human behaviour and thereby explain the social world in the way a natural scientist would do.
- Constitutive theories are those that help construct the world. Most of the recent approaches, ranging from critical theories to post-modernist theories, tend to be constitutive in the sense that these theories are not external to the things they are trying to explain and they just attempt to construct how one